

Absolutely — **some** is a very useful grammar/polyfunctionality target because your passage uses it in **two different grammatical ways**:

> “...and **some smaller ones** are kept on a sunny balcony...”

and

> “...she gives **some** to neighbours and relatives...”

In the first sentence, **some** is a **determiner** meaning **an unspecified number of**. In the second, it is a **pronoun** replacing an already understood noun such as *tomatoes or lemons*.

Word family / grammar family: **some / somebody / someone / something / somewhere**

Base form: some

Part of speech / function: determiner (限定詞) / pronoun (代名詞) / adverb-like approximator (近似數量用法)

Core ideas:

- * an unspecified amount/number;
- * part, but not all;
- * certain unspecified people/things;
- * approximately, in some numerical contexts.

Unlike a lexical word such as **garden**, **some** is mainly a grammar/polyfunctionality word.

Meaning 1 in your passage: **some + plural noun/substitute = 一些 ; 有些**

Your sentence:

> “...and **some smaller ones** are kept on a sunny balcony...”

Here:

> **some smaller ones = some smaller plants**

繁體中文 :

數量沒有明確指出的一部分 ; 一些 / 有些

Natural translation:

> “Some smaller ones are kept on a sunny balcony.”

「而**一些較小的植物**則放在陽光充足的露台上。」

So here:

> **some = 一些 / 有些**

Meaning 2 in your passage: **some = some of them / an unspecified amount — 一些**

Your second sentence:

> “...she gives **some** to neighbours and relatives...”

Here **some** stands alone as a pronoun.

It means:

> **some of the tomatoes, lemons, or produce she has grown**

Natural translation:

> “She gives some to neighbours and relatives.”

「她會送**一些**給鄰居和親戚。」

So here:

> **some = 前文所指東西中的一部分**

1. **some + plural countable noun — 一些 ; 有些**

The basic determiner use.

Practice 1

> “She grows **some herbs** on the balcony.”

「她在露台種了**一些香草**。」

Practice 2

> “Some plants need more sunlight.”

「**有些植物**需要更多陽光。」

some + plural countable noun = 數量未具體指出的幾個 / 一些人或事物

2. **some + uncountable noun — 一些；若干**

Practice 3

> “Add **some water** to the soil.”

「在泥土中加**一些水**。」

Practice 4

> “She needs **some advice**.”

「她需要**一些建議**。」

some + uncountable noun = 數量未具體指出的一部分不可數事物

Examples:

* some water

* some information

* some time

* some money

3. **some = pronoun, part of a known group/amount — 一些；一部分**

This is your second source use.

Practice 5 — Original

> “She gives **some** to neighbours.”

「她會送**一些**給鄰居。」

Practice 6

> “I bought several lemons and used **some** for the cake.”

「我買了幾個檸檬，拿了**一些**來做蛋糕。」

Practice 7

> “Some were ripe, but others were still green.”

「**有些**已經成熟，但其他的仍然是青的。」

some — pronoun = 前面已知的一群人 / 物或一批東西中的一部分

4. **some of + the/these/those/possessive/pronoun —中的一些**

A major specific-group pattern.

Practice 8

> “**Some of these plants** need more shade.”

「**這些植物中的一些**需要更多陰涼。」

Practice 9

> “Some of my friends grow herbs.”

「我的朋友中**有些人**會種香草。」

Practice 10

> “Some of them are ready.”

「它們當中**有些**已經成熟了。」

some of = 某個已明確限定群體中的一部分

Common:

* some of the students

* some of these plants

* some of my time

* some of them

5. **some = certain unspecified people/things — 某些；有些**

Sometimes **some** means not just “a quantity,” but **certain members whose identity is not specified**.

Practice 11

> “**Some people** prefer growing vegetables to flowers.”

「**有些人**比較喜歡種蔬菜而不是花。」

Practice 12

> “Some varieties grow better in cooler weather.”

「**某些品種**在較涼的天氣下長得更好。」

some = 某些，但沒有指出具體是哪一些

This is especially common in general statements.

6. **some + singular countable noun = 某個；某一個**

This is an important use learners often miss.

Practice 13

> “**Some man** called while you were out.”

「你不在時有**某個男人**打過電話來。」

Practice 14

> “She heard the idea from some gardening website.”

「她是在**某個園藝網站**看到這個想法的。」

some + singular noun = 某一個身份不清楚、無須指出或說話者不記得的人 / 事物

Often carries:

* “某個”

* “有個”

* “某一”

7. **some + number = approximately — 約；大約**

A useful formal/written use.

Practice 15

> “The garden contains **some 30 species** of plants.”

「這個花園有**大約 30 種**植物。」

Practice 16

> “The project took some six months to complete.”

「這個項目用了**大約六個月**完成。」

some + number = approximately / about

Register:

* somewhat formal;

* common in journalism/reporting.

So:

> some 30 people

> = 約 30 人

8. **some = quite a remarkable/impressive one — 真是個……；相當了不起的**

A less common but established emphatic use.

Practice 17

> “That was **some garden**!”

「那真是個**很厲害的花園！**」

Practice 18

> “She is some gardener.”

「她真是個**很有本事的園藝高手**。」

****some + singular noun — emphatic = 非同一般、相當突出 / 令人印象深刻的****

Register:

- * informal;
- * expressive;
- * often American English.

This is very different from ordinary “some = 一些”.

9. ****some...others... = 有些.....其他的.....****

A very common contrast pattern.

Practice 19

> **“**Some plants** need full sun; **others** prefer shade.”**

「****有些植物****需要充足日照，****其他的****則喜歡陰涼。」

Practice 20

> “Some students agreed, while others disagreed.”

「****有些學生****同意，而其他人不同意。」

****some...others... = 一部分.....另一部分.....****

This is especially useful for classification and comparison.

10. ****some...some... = 有些.....有些.....****

Practice 21

> **“**Some** are red, and **some** are yellow.”**

「****有些****是紅色，****有些****是黃色。」

Practice 22

> “Some people relax by reading; some prefer exercise.”

「有些人靠閱讀放鬆；**有些人**則喜歡運動。」

some...some... = 把一個群體分成不同未指明部分

11. **some time = 一些時間；一段時間**

Be careful with spacing.

Practice 23

> “I need **some time** to finish this.”

「我需要**一些時間**完成這件事。」

Practice 24

> “Give the plants some time to recover.”

「給植物**一點時間**恢復。」

some time = an unspecified amount of time = 一些時間

12. **sometime = 某個時候**

Different word.

Practice 25

> “Let’s visit the garden **sometime**.”

「我們**找個時間 / 改天**去看看花園吧。」

Practice 26

> “I met her sometime last year.”

「我在去年**某個時候**見過她。」

sometime = at an unspecified time = 某時 / 找個時間

Not the same as:

> some time = 一段時間

13. **sometimes = 有時候**

Another different word.

Practice 27

> “I **sometimes** water the plants in the evening.”

「我**有時候**晚上替植物澆水。」

Practice 28

> “Sometimes the weather changes quickly.”

「天氣**有時**變得很快。」

sometimes = on some occasions, but not always = 有時候

Important:

* some time

* sometime

* sometimes

are three different forms.

14. **somewhere = 某處；某個地方**

A useful family extension.

Practice 29

> “Put the pot **somewhere sunny**.”

「把花盆放在**某個陽光充足的地方**。」

Practice 30

> “I left my keys somewhere in the kitchen.”

「我把鎖匙留在廚房裡的**某個地方**了。」

****somewhere = at/in an unspecified place****

15. ****someone / somebody = 某人；有人****

Practice 31

> “****Someone**** is at the door.”

「門口****有人****。」

Practice 32

> “She gave the flowers to somebody nearby.”

「她把花送給附近的****某個人****。」

****someone / somebody = 身份未指出或未知的一個人****

These are very close in meaning.

16. ****something = 某物；某件事****

Practice 33

> “There is ****something**** wrong with the plant.”

「這棵植物****有點問題 / 有某些地方不對勁****。」

Practice 34

> “She wants to grow something different.”

「她想種****一些不同的東西 / 某種不同的植物****。」

****something = 某個未具體說明的事物 / 事情****

17. ****something like + amount = 大約；差不多****

A useful related pattern.

Practice 35

> “There were **something like twenty plants** on the roof.”

「屋頂上有**大約二十棵植物**。」

Practice 36

> “It took **something like an hour**.”

「這大概花了**一小時左右**。」

something like + number/amount = approximately

This is conversational.

18. **and then some = 還不止；甚至更多**

A useful idiom.

Practice 37

> “The repair cost a thousand dollars **and then some**.”

「維修費花了一千元，**甚至還不止**。」

Practice 38

> “She grew enough vegetables for the family and then some.”

「她種的蔬菜足夠全家食用，**而且還有多餘**。」

and then some = 比剛才提到的數量 / 程度還要更多

Register: informal.

Important distinction: **some vs any**

This is the biggest learner contrast.

****some****

commonly used in affirmative statements:

> “I have some plants.”

「我有一些植物。」

****any****

commonly used in negatives/questions:

> “I don’t have any plants.”

「我沒有任何植物。」

> “Do you have any plants?”

「你有植物嗎？」

But this is ****not an absolute rule****.

Important distinction: ****some in questions****

Use ****some**** in questions when:

- * offering;
- * requesting;
- * expecting/encouraging a “yes”.

Offer:

> “Would you like ****some tea****?”

「你想喝點茶嗎？」

Request:

> “Could I have ****some water****?”

「我可以要一點水嗎？」

Using ****any**** would sound more neutral/open-ended in many questions.

Important distinction: ****some vs a few****

****some****

unspecified number.

****a few****

specifically a small number.

> “She grows some herbs.”

= 她種一些香草，數量不明。

> “She grows a few herbs.”

= 她種幾種 / 幾棵香草，明確表示數量不多。

Important distinction: ****some vs several****

****some****

vague quantity.

****several****

more specifically:

more than two, but not many.

> some plants

> = 一些植物

> several plants

> = 幾棵 / 數棵植物

Important distinction: ****some vs many****

****some****

does not specify whether the number is large or small.

many

explicitly means a large number.

> some people

> = 有些人

> many people

> = 很多人

Important distinction: **some vs most**

You already curated **most**.

some

= part of a group, quantity unspecified.

most

= majority of the group.

> “Some plants survived.”

= 有些活下來。

> “Most plants survived.”

= 大部分活下來。

Most is proportionally much stronger.

Important distinction: **some vs all**

You also curated **all**.

some

= part, not necessarily all.

all

= entire group/amount.

> some of the plants

> = 其中一些

> all of the plants

> = 全部

Important distinction: **some vs one**

some

may refer to multiple items or an unspecified amount.

one

specifically one unit.

> some flowers

> = 一些花

> one flower

> = 一朵花

But:

> some man

means:

> 某個男人

rather than several men.

Important distinction: **some vs certain**

some

can mean "certain unspecified".

> “Some people disagree.”

****certain****

more strongly suggests particular people exist, though unnamed.

> “Certain people disagree.”

= 某些特定的人不同意。

****Certain**** can sound more deliberate/formal.

Important distinction: ****some vs part****

****some****

grammar word indicating an unspecified amount.

****part****

noun meaning a portion/component.

> “I ate some of the cake.”

= 我吃了一些蛋糕。

> “I ate part of the cake.”

= 我吃了蛋糕的一部分。

Close, but ****part**** emphasizes division/portion more explicitly.

Important distinction: ****some of vs some****

General/indefinite:

> “Some plants need shade.”

Specific known group:

> “Some of these plants need shade.”

So:

> some plants = 一些植物，泛指

> some of these plants = 這些特定植物中的一些

Important distinction: ****some of them vs some ones****

Correct:

> ****some of them**** 

> ****some smaller ones**** 

But normally not:

> ***some ones*** 

Why?

****ones**** usually needs a modifier:

> some smaller ones

> some red ones

> some new ones

Without a modifier, use:

> some

> some of them

Important distinction: ****some time / sometime / sometimes****

This is highly testable.

****some time****

= 一些時間 / 一段時間

> “I need some time.”

****sometime****

= 某個時候

> “Call me sometime.”

sometimes

= 有時候

> “I sometimes walk there.”

Three different meanings and spellings.

Important distinction: **someone vs some one**

someone

= 某人

some one

rare, two words, used only when strongly emphasizing one particular member of a group.

Example:

> “Some one of these keys must fit.”

This is rare/formal. For normal learner usage, **someone** is the important form.

Grammar note: singular agreement after **someone/somebody/something**

These take singular verbs:

> Someone **is** outside. ✓

> Something **has** changed. ✓

Even though their identity is unknown.

Grammar / family sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory is:

* **some + plural noun** = 一些 / 有些
 * **some + uncountable noun** = 一些 / 若干
 * **some — pronoun** = 一些 / 一部分
 * **some of + specific group** =中的一些
 * **some = certain unspecified** = 某些
 * **some + singular noun** = 某個
 * **some + number** = 大約
 * **some — emphatic** = 非同一般 / 很厲害的
 * **some...others...** = 有些.....其他的.....
 * **some time** = 一些時間
 * **sometime** = 某個時候
 * **sometimes** = 有時候
 * **someone/somebody** = 某人
 * **something** = 某物 / 某事
 * **somewhere** = 某處
 * **something like + number** = 大約
 * **and then some** = 還不止 / 甚至更多

Master comparison

Form / pattern	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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some + plural noun	數量未具體指出的若干人 / 事物；一些 / 有些
some + uncountable noun	數量未具體指出的一部分不可數事物
some — pronoun	已知群體 / 數量中的一部分，省略後面的名詞
some of + specific group	某個已限定群體中的一部分
some — certain unspecified	某些特定但沒有說明是哪一些的人 / 事物
some + singular noun	某一個身份未知、不重要或未指出的人 / 事物
some + number	大約某個數量；約.....
some — emphatic	非同一般、相當突出或令人印象深刻的
**some...others... **	將群體分為「一些.....其他的.....」
some time	一段未明確指定長度的時間
sometime	某個未明確指定的時間
sometimes	在某些時候，但不是總是；有時候
someone / somebody	身份未知或未指出的某個人
something	未具體說明的某物 / 某件事
somewhere	未具體說明的某個地方
something like + number	約莫、大約某個數量
and then some	比已提到的數量 / 程度還要更多

For your original passage

You have **two useful uses**:

> “...and **some smaller ones** are kept on a sunny balcony...”

Here:

some = 數量未指定的幾個 / 一些

and:

> “...she gives **some** to neighbours and relatives...”

Here:

some = 代替已知的 tomatoes / lemons / produce , 表示其中一部分

Natural translations:

> **「一些較小的植物則放在陽光充足的露台上。」**

> **「她會送一些給鄰居和親戚。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

> **some plants** → 一些植物

> **some of these plants** → 這些植物中的一些

> **some** → 一些, 名詞省略

> **some man** → 某個男人

> **some 20 people** → 大約 20 人

> **some vs any** → 常見肯定語境 vs 常見疑問 / 否定語境

> **some vs most** → 一部分 vs 大部分

> **some vs all** → 一些 vs 全部

> **some time** → 一段時間

> **sometime** → 某個時候

> **sometimes** → 有時候